Rashon Poole

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

I research how AI can support human agency in contexts where information, values, and perspectives are contested. My research spans AI alignment, agentic systems, and human-AI interaction, focusing on operationalizing social science constructs such as values and convictions into AI behavior. I examine the fairness and societal implications of AI systems.

EDUCATION

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI — 2025 - Current
Ph.D. in Computer Science & Engineering
Advisor: Farnaz Jahanbakhsh

Stanford University, Stanford, CA — 2023 - 2025
Master of Science, Computer Science | Concentration: AI

Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI — 2019 - 2022
Bachelor of Science, Computer Science | Minor: Business

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Hess Corporation, Houston, TX — Summer 2024
IT Intern, Custom Applications, Integration, & Automation Team
- Automated app service deployments using Azure DevOps and YAML-based CI/CD pipelines.

Hess Corporation, Houston, TX — Summer 2023
IT Intern, Digital Enablement & Architecture Team
- Developed generative AI apps for company-specific Q&A and automated meeting summaries.

GE Aviation, Grand Rapids, MI — Summer 2022
Systems Engineer Intern, Connected Aircraft User Interface Team
- Developed a React.js interface with API integrations for data visualization and management.

Cisco Systems, Seattle, WA — Summer 2021
Software Engineer Intern, iOS Webex Team
- Developed an iOS home screen widget for Webex displaying recent contacts and messages.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Stanford Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence (HAI), Stanford, CA — 2024 - Current
Research Assistant, PI: Shriti Raj
- Researched multimodal AI for diabetes decision support, developing a dashboard that provides personalized insights and explanations of glycemic events from patient data.

Stanford Center for Racial Justice (SCRJ), Stanford, CA — 2024 - 2025
Research Assistant, PI: Ralph Richard Banks
- Researched AI bias and racial discrimination across legal domains, contributing to scholarship on AI policy.

Electrical Machines and Power Electronics Research (EMPowER), East Lansing, MI — 2022
Undergraduate Research Assistant, PI: Shanelle Foster
- Applied genetic algorithms to optimize and visualize multi-objective electric motor designs.

PUBLICATIONS

Personalized Alignment of Language Models with Human Value Profiles — EMNLP Main 2026
Rashon Poole, Farnaz Jahanbakhsh
Proceedings of the 2026 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing [Paper]

Unpacking AI Bias and the Antidiscrimination Law Dilemma SLR 2026
Hoang Pham, Hannah Cha, **Rashon Poole**.
Stanford Law Review Online, Volume 79, 112 [Paper]

Oak story: improving learner outcomes with LLM-mediated interactive narratives UIST 2025
Alan Y Cheng, Carolyn Q Zou, Anthony Xie, Matthew Hsu, Felicia Yan, Felicity Huang, David K Zhang, Arjun Sharma, **Rashon Poole,** Daniel Wan Rosli, Andrea Cuadra, Roy Pea, James A Landay
Proceedings of the 38th Annual ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology [Paper]

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Performed a combination of teaching responsibilities, including leading discussion sections, holding office hours, grading assignments, developing course materials, and mentoring student projects.

University of Michigan: Teaching Assistant **2026**
- EECS 485: Web Systems (Instructor: Andrew DeOrio, Raed Almomani) Fall 2026

Stanford University: Course Assistant **2023 - 2025**
- CS193P: Developing Apps for iOS (Instructor: Paul Hegarty) Spring 2025
- CS205L: Continuous Math Methods with an Emphasis on Machine Learning (Instructor: Ron Fedkiw) Winter 2025
- CS147L: Cross-Platform Mobile App Development (Instructors: James Landay, Alan Cheng) Autumn 2023, Autumn 2024
- CS224N: Natural Language Processing with Deep Learning (Instructor: Chris Manning) Spring 2024
- CS144: Introduction to Computer Networking (Instructor: Keith Winstein) Winter 2024

HONORS & AWARDS

Rackham Merit Fellowship, University of Michigan 2025
- Doctoral fellowship recognizing academic excellence, research potential, and contributions to the broader community.

MSCS Fellowship, Stanford University 2023
- Full tuition and financial support through an assistantship offered to Stanford's strongest incoming MSCS students.

GEM Fellowship, National GEM Consortium 2023
- Fellowship supporting graduate study in STEM through tuition funding, stipends, and industry research opportunities.

Amazon Sigma Award, Michigan State University 2022
- Recognizing the senior capstone team that delivers the best overall design experience

Chrysler Scholarship, Michigan State University 2021 and 2022
- Support recruiting efforts of DaimlerChrysler Corporation in hiring students from historically disadvantaged backgrounds

Supporting Excellent Engineers (SEE) Scholar, NSF S-STEM Program 2020
- Selected as an NSF-funded SEE Scholar for academic excellence in engineering

SERVICE

Student Organizer: University of Michigan HCI Seminar 2025 - Current
Reviewer: University of Michigan CSE Undergraduate Research Symposium Spring 2025

SKILLS

AI/ML: PyTorch, Activation Steering, Fine-tuning (LoRA), RAG, LLMs, Multi-Agent
Software Engineering: React, Django/Flask, iOS/Android Dev, React Native
Cloud/Deployment: AWS, Azure Cloud, Google Cloud, GitHub Actions
Languages: JavaScript, Python, C/C++, HTML/CSS, SQL